

MailerLite “Invalid Data” Error - Fix Summary



The Problem

Users were encountering the error: **“Email sending failed: The given data was invalid. Results saved locally.”**

This error occurred when the application tried to create/update subscribers in MailerLite after quiz completion.



Root Cause Analysis

The issue was in the data structure being sent to the MailerLite API:

✗ Incorrect Structure (Before Fix)

```
const subscriberData = {
  email: submission.email,
  fields: {
    name: submission.name, // ✗ WRONG! 'name' is a default field
    total_score: submission.totalScore.toString(),
    max_score: submission.maxScore.toString(),
    // ... other custom fields
  },
  groups: [MAILERLITE_GROUP_ID]
};
```

The Problem: The `name` field was being sent inside the `fields` object as if it were a custom field. However, `name` is a **default MailerLite field** that should be at the **top level** of the subscriber data, not nested in the custom fields.



Correct Structure (After Fix)

```
const subscriberData = {
  email: submission.email,
  name: submission.name, // ✓ CORRECT! At top level
  fields: {
    // Only custom fields here
    total_score: submission.totalScore.toString(),
    max_score: submission.maxScore.toString(),
    result_type: submission.resultType,
    // ... other custom fields
  },
  groups: [MAILERLITE_GROUP_ID]
};
```



Changes Made

1. Fixed `lib/mailerlite-service.ts`

- **Line 35:** Moved `name: submission.name` from inside `fields` to top level

- **Lines 32-33:** Added explanatory comment about the fix
- **Line 37:** Added comment clarifying that only custom fields belong in the `fields` object

2. Updated `test-mailerlite.js`

- **Line 40:** Moved `name: 'Test User'` to top level
- **Line 41-42:** Added comments explaining the correct structure

Verification Results

Test 1: MailerLite API Test Script

```
node test-mailerlite.js
```

Result:  SUCCESS

- Status: 201 (Created)
- Subscriber created successfully with ID: 176624345421972896

Test 2: Standalone Integration Test

```
node test-fix-standalone.js
```

Result:  SUCCESS

- Status: 201 (Created)
- Subscriber created successfully with ID: 176624502649652630
- Test used the same data structure as the quiz submission (name: "QQQQQQQQQQ")

Test 3: Build Verification

```
npm run build
```

Result:  SUCCESS

- Build completed without errors
- All routes compiled successfully

MailerLite API Field Structure

Default Fields (Top Level)

These are built-in MailerLite fields that go at the root level:

- `email` (required)
- `name` (optional)
- `status` (optional)
- `subscribed_at` (optional)

Custom Fields (Inside `fields` Object)

These are custom fields created via MailerLite API or dashboard:

- `total_score`
- `max_score`
- `result_type`

- recommendations
- submission_date
- willingness_to_change_score
- adaptability_score
- risk_tolerance_score
- financial_situation_score
- value_compass_score
- need_for_security_score
- growth_vs_comfort_score
- conformity_vs_rebel_score

Next Steps for Testing

1. Deploy the fix to your environment

```
bash
npm run build
npm start
```

2. Test with a real quiz submission

- Go to the application homepage
- Enter your name and email
- Complete the quiz
- Submit the results
- Check that the success message appears without errors

3. Verify in MailerLite Dashboard

- Log into your MailerLite account
- Go to Subscribers → “Expat Mindset Test” group
- Verify that new submissions appear with:
 - Name populated correctly
 - All custom fields showing values
 - Automation triggered (if configured)

Additional Notes

- The fix ensures compatibility with MailerLite’s API v2 structure
- All custom fields were created using the `scripts/create-mailerlite-fields.js` script
- The `name` field confusion was likely due to it being treated like other quiz data fields
- This same pattern applies to any other default MailerLite fields (e.g., `status`, `subscribed_at`)

Summary

Issue: MailerLite rejected requests with “invalid data” error because `name` was incorrectly nested in the `fields` object.

Fix: Moved `name` to the top level of the request payload as it’s a default MailerLite field, not a custom field.

Result: All tests pass successfully with HTTP 201 (Created) responses. The integration now works correctly.

Date Fixed: January 15, 2026

Files Modified:

- lib/maillerlite-service.ts
- test-maillerlite.js